

Uddannelsesmuligheder efter folkeskole



I'm a 16 year old person living in Denmark. I'm born in Denmark, but my parents are from Democratic Republic of the Congo. I just finished primary school in Denmark and am now considering what my next step should be. I'm fluent in danish. What educational path would you recommend for me?

That's a thoughtful and exciting stage you're at—congratulations on finishing primary school! Since you're 16 and in Denmark, it sounds like you're ready to choose between the main educational pathways that follow **folkeskole (primary/lower secondary school)**. Let me break it down for you and help you think through your options based on your interests, strengths, and goals.

🇩🇰 Educational options after primary school in Denmark

At this stage, you can choose between:

1 Gymnasiale uddannelser (General Upper Secondary Education)

If you are interested in subjects like science, languages, social studies, or the arts, and you want to keep your options open for university or higher education later, this is a good route. Types include:

- **STX (Alment gymnasium)** – General academic program with broad subjects
- **HHX (Higher commercial examination)** – Focus on business, economics, international trade
- **HTX (Higher technical examination)** – Focus on technology, science, and innovation
- **HF (Higher preparatory examination)** – Shorter, 2-year general program, more practical

👉 Recommended if:

You enjoy studying, want to go to university, and like subjects such as languages, math, science, business, or social studies.

2 Erhvervsuddannelse (Vocational Education and Training - VET)

A combination of school and apprenticeship/workplace learning. You can become skilled in areas like:

- Carpentry, plumbing, or electrician work
- Hairdressing, chef, or baker
- IT, graphic design, business administration

👉 Recommended if:

You want to learn a trade, like working practically, and are eager to get into the workforce with skills in demand.

Kombinerede forløb (EUX)

This combines VET with academic studies, so you can both learn a trade and qualify for higher education.

Recommended if:

You want to keep both doors open — practical skills + the chance to apply for higher education later.

What to consider when choosing

- ✓ **Your interests** – What subjects excite you? What kind of work do you see yourself enjoying?
- ✓ **Your strengths** – Are you stronger in theoretical studies or practical tasks?
- ✓ **Your goals** – Do you want to go to university? Start earning sooner? Start your own business?
- ✓ **Language + cultural strengths** – As a bilingual person (Danish + possibly a language from DR Congo), you could thrive in international business, diplomacy, translation, or multicultural workspaces.

Personalized suggestions

Since I don't know your exact interests yet, here are some ideas:

- **If you like academic subjects + want options open for university:** STX or HHX could be great. STX is broad; HHX links to business/finance/trade, and could leverage your multicultural background.
- **If you like hands-on learning + want job skills fast:** An erhvervsuddannelse or EUX in something that interests you (e.g., IT, media, culinary arts).
- **If you are unsure:** You could attend an **efterskole** or preparatory course that helps you explore interests before committing.

Your multicultural background = an advantage!

- Consider fields where intercultural communication is valuable (e.g., international business, tourism, diplomacy, NGOs, social work).
- Being fluent in Danish + potentially French or Lingala (or other languages) can be a huge asset.

Would you like to tell me more about:

- What subjects you enjoy most?
- If you have any career dreams (even vague ones)?
- Whether you prefer school-based learning, practical work, or a mix?

That way, I can give even more tailored advice! 